

NAAN

CD23731 - FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

N GOKUL KRISHNA 231701014

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ANNA UNIVERSITY, CHENNAI

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RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Report titled "NAAN" is the bonafide work of **N GOKUL KRISHNA (231701014)** who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

Signature of the Supervisor

Dr. Gunasekar
Assistant Professor
Department of Computer Science and Design
Rajalakshmi Engineering College

Submitted to the CD23731 - Film Making and Radio Podcasting Examination held on
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Signature of Internal Examiner

Signature of External Examiner

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ANNEXURE III

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 About the Film

"Naan" (நான்), meaning "I" or "Me", is a 7-minute-10-second Tamil short film. It is an emotional drama that looks at how an experience of childhood bullying can stay with a person long after it is over, even when that person appears completely normal from the outside.

The story follows a college student who is shown as cheerful and socially connected. He attends class, carries his backpack, and jokes with his friends. His visit to a counsellor slowly changes how the audience sees him. During the counselling session, the film moves between the present and flashbacks to his childhood, where he was pushed around, knocked down and left alone by a group of boys.

The film ends outdoors on a beach. The protagonist walks beside the sea, still carrying his backpack, and looks out at the water. The ending suggests that he has spoken about his past and is ready to move forward with it rather than be defined by it.

The film was created as a student filmmaking project. It focuses on telling a personal and meaningful story through performance, camera framing, editing and sound.

1.2 Background

The main objective of the project was to gain practical experience in the complete filmmaking process, from an original story idea to a finished short film.

The project provided experience in:

- Developing a short-film concept around a social issue.
- Writing a screenplay and dialogue.
- Planning scenes and locations.
- Directing actors, including the younger characters in the flashback.
- Operating a camera and planning shot composition.
- Maintaining continuity between present-day and flashback scenes.
- Editing video and audio.
- Adding sound effects and background music.
- Applying colour correction to separate the present from the past.
- Presenting a complete narrative within a limited duration.

1.3 Theme and Message

The central theme of "**Naan**" is the hidden effect of bullying and the importance of speaking about painful experiences. The film is not only about a single incident of bullying. It is about the person who remains afterwards and the emotional weight he carries.

The title reflects this idea. "Naan" asks a simple question: who am I beneath what everyone else sees? The cheerful college student and the lonely boy in the flashback are the same person, and the film asks the audience to look beyond appearances.

The message of the film is:

"You don't always know what someone is carrying inside."

The final resolution reinforces this idea by showing that support and conversation, not silence, help a person move forward.

CHAPTER 2

STORY & CHARACTERS

2.1 Story Synopsis

The film begins with the title "Naan". A college student, wearing his ID card and carrying a backpack, walks through his surroundings and meets his classmates. In class, a group of friends sits together, joking and laughing. He takes part in their conversations, and everything about his life appears ordinary.

The film then shows him sitting in a counsellor's office. The counsellor listens and asks questions, and the conversation becomes more serious. As he speaks, the film moves to a darker, differently coloured flashback of a younger boy. He is with other boys in an open area with bicycles. The boys are not friendly. He is knocked to the ground while the others stand around him, and the film shows him being overpowered and left alone afterwards. In one shot the boy sits alone under a tree.

The film returns several times to the counsellor's room. The counsellor continues to listen without judging, and the protagonist starts to put into words what he has kept inside for years. A dark, isolated scene shows him looking upward against a black background, in contrast to the crowded college scenes at the beginning.

In the final sequence, the protagonist walks along a beach in his college clothes and backpack, walks towards the sea and looks out at the water. The open space, the sky and the ocean are a visual contrast to the confined classrooms, the counsellor's office and the dark memories.

2.2 Main Characters

Character	Role
The Protagonist (college student)	Central character; the cheerful student who carries a painful childhood memory. Played by Richard
Childhood Protagonist	The younger version of the protagonist in the flashback.
The Counsellor	Listens to the protagonist and helps him talk about his past.
College Friends	The group of classmates who see only his outer personality.
The Boys in the Flashback	The group of boys who bully the younger protagonist.

2.3 Character Development

The protagonist changes emotionally during the film, although his outward behaviour changes very little. At the beginning he is relaxed, friendly and part of a group. During the

counselling session he becomes quieter and more serious as the memories return. In the flashbacks he appears afraid, vulnerable and alone.

The important change happens after the past is revealed. He does not deny the memory or pretend it did not happen. He speaks about it and accepts the counsellor's support. By the ending he is calm, and the character development is a move from **silence to expression**, and from **carrying the past alone to moving forward with support**.

The film also does not show him as weak. He goes to college, has friends and functions normally. It shows that surviving an experience and fully recovering from it are not always the same thing.

2.4 Message

The film communicates that a person can laugh with friends, attend college and appear confident, and still be struggling because of something that happened years earlier. It encourages the audience to be understanding, because the problem is often hidden.

The film also shows that speaking about the problem and receiving support is an important step. The closing idea is that the past is part of a person's story but does not have to be the whole of his identity.

2.5 Use of Flashback and Counselling

The counselling session is the main storytelling device of the film. It gives the audience a reason to see the past, because the flashbacks appear as the protagonist speaks. The film therefore moves between the present-day conversation and the memories that explain it.

This creates two layers in the story. The present layer is calm and conversational, with the counsellor listening. The past layer is emotional and physical, showing what actually happened. The contrast helps the audience understand that the cheerful student and the bullied boy are the same person.

The film moves from crowd, to friends, to conversation, to counselling, to memory and finally to isolation. This takes the audience from the protagonist's outer life into his inner world.

2.6 Symbolism of the Backpack and the Sea

The **backpack** appears in the college scenes and again on the beach. Because the protagonist is still carrying it at the end, it can be read as the weight of his past. His past has not disappeared, but he is now moving forward while carrying it.

The **sea** represents freedom, release and moving forward. The film has mostly used confined and dark spaces such as classrooms, the counsellor's office and the flashbacks. The wide sky, natural light and open water on the beach give the ending the emotional space that the rest of the film lacks.

The **tree** in the flashback, under which the boy sits alone after the incident, shows his isolation and how he was left to deal with what had happened by himself.

2.7 Emotional Progression

The emotions of the film were designed to change progressively.

Stage	Protagonist's Emotional State
Opening (college)	Cheerful, relaxed and sociable
With friends	Outwardly normal, hiding something deeper
Counselling begins	Serious and hesitant
Flashback	Afraid, vulnerable and isolated
Dark scene	Completely alone with his thoughts
After the revelation	Open and supported
Beach ending	Calm and ready to move forward

This progression keeps the film from feeling repetitive and gives the audience a clear emotional journey in a short time.

CHAPTER 3

PRE-PRODUCTION

3.1 Script Development

The script was written by N GOKUL KRISHNA over approximately 5 days. The starting idea was to show that people often carry experiences that others cannot see, and that speaking about them helps. The title "Naan" was chosen because the story is about the person beneath the outer appearance.

The story was kept simple so that it could be made with limited resources, with a small number of characters and locations. The structure alternates between the present-day counselling and the flashback, and special attention was given to writing the counsellor's conversation so that it felt natural and calm rather than dramatic.

3.2 Scene Planning

The scenes were planned around the major stages of the story:

1. Title and introduction of the college student.
2. College surroundings and meeting the classmates.
3. Friends in class, joking and laughing.
4. The protagonist in the counsellor's office.
5. Conversation with the counsellor begins.
6. Flashback: the younger boy with the group of boys and the bicycles.
7. Flashback: the bullying and the boy left alone under the tree.
8. Return to the counsellor and continuation of the conversation.
9. The dark, isolated scene.
10. The beach: the protagonist walks towards the sea.

This structure gives the film a clear beginning, middle and end within the runtime of 7 minutes 10 seconds.

3.3 Locations

The film was shot in real locations that could be easily accessed:

- College classroom and campus surroundings
- Counsellor's office
- Open area for the childhood flashback (with bicycles and a tree)
- Dark set-up for the isolated scene

- Beach

Using real locations reduced the production requirements and allowed the team to concentrate on performance, framing and storytelling. The locations were also chosen to support the contrast in the story: closed and dark spaces for the past and the counselling, and open space for the ending.

3.4 Cast and Crew

Name	Role
N Gokul Krishna	[Director / Writer]
Richard	Actor — The Protagonist
Senthil	Actor — Childhood Protagonist
Suyambulakshmi	Actor — The Counsellor
Navin, nivas, rohit	Actors — Friends and the boys in the flashback
Kavi	Cameraman

3.5 Production Planning

Since the film moves between two timelines, continuity was an important part of the planning. The team had to keep the appearance of the present-day scenes consistent, and to plan the flashback so that it felt clearly different in its setting, lighting and mood.

The film deals with a sensitive subject, so the bullying scenes were planned carefully. The aim was to show the emotional impact of bullying rather than to show violence in detail, and to make sure the people acting were comfortable and safe during the scenes.

CHAPTER 4 PRODUCTION

4.1 Shooting Process

The shooting was completed over 7 days across the planned locations. The production followed the screenplay and concentrated on the important story moments without unnecessary scenes.

The present-day scenes and the flashback scenes were planned as separate groups so that the visual difference between them could be maintained. Multiple takes were recorded when needed, particularly for the counselling conversation and the emotional moments.

4.2 Camera

The film was recorded using camera an smartphone with tripod. Stable framing was used for the counselling scenes to give them a calm and steady feel. The camera was placed at the level of the characters to keep the audience close to their emotions.

For the ending, wider shots were used on the beach to show the sea and open sky. This is a contrast to the closer and more confined shots used in the classroom, the counsellor's office and the flashback.

4.3 Lighting

External lighting was used in som scenes. The film mainly used available natural and room lighting. The lighting was used to support the story: normal and bright for the college scenes, darker for the flashbacks, a very dark background for the isolated scene, and natural daylight on the beach. This progression from dark and enclosed lighting to open natural light supports the emotional movement from the past to acceptance.

4.4 Audio

The dialogue was recorded using microphone . The film is in Tamil, and the counselling conversation in particular required clear and natural delivery, as it is the main way the protagonist expresses what he has been holding inside.

Additional sound elements and background music were added in post-production to support the mood of each part of the film.

4.5 Direction

The film was directed by N Gokul Krishna. The direction concentrated on the protagonist's emotional changes. His performance was adjusted through the film in the following way:

Cheerful → Serious → Vulnerable → Open → Calm

For the flashback, the younger actors were guided to show fear and isolation naturally and without exaggeration. The counsellor was directed to be calm and patient, so that the conversation feels safe and non-judgemental.

CHAPTER 5

POST-PRODUCTION

5.1 Video Editing

The film was edited using premier pro. The editing process involved:

- Selecting suitable takes.
- Trimming unnecessary footage.
- Arranging the scenes according to the screenplay.
- Cutting between the counselling session and the flashback.
- Adding the title and transitions.
- Maintaining the pace of the 7-minute-10-second film.

The editing was particularly important because the film depends on moving between the present and the past. The cuts were timed so that the flashbacks appear as a natural result of what the protagonist is saying.

5.2 Sound and Music

Background music and sound effects were added during editing. It was kept soft and gentle so that it supports the emotional scenes without overpowering the dialogue, and the flashback and the dark scene use quieter sound to increase the feeling of isolation. The beach sequence uses **natural sound** to give the ending a sense of release.

5.3 Colour Correction

Colour correction and grading were done using premier pro. The main purpose was to separate the timelines visually. The flashback was given a darker, memory-like tone, while the present-day scenes and the beach were kept natural and bright. Basic adjustments to brightness and contrast were also made to keep shots recorded at different times consistent.

5.4 Titles and Final Presentation

The final stage of editing included the title "Naan", the credits and the final presentation. The title appears at the beginning of the film and introduces its central question of identity.

The final image of the protagonist walking towards the sea with his backpack was kept as the closing moment, since it summarises the message of the film: that he is moving forward and carrying his past with him.

CHAPTER 6

CONCLUSION

6.1 Final Outcome

"Naan" was completed as a 7-minute-10-second Tamil short film. The film uses the counselling session and flashbacks to explain the emotional effects of childhood bullying, and shows that a person who seems perfectly fine may still carry the past.

The project demonstrates how a short film can communicate a meaningful idea through a combination of screenplay, performance, cinematography, editing and sound.

6.2 Challenges Faced

Handling a Sensitive Subject:

Showing bullying and its emotional effects required care. The aim was to be honest about the impact without being disturbing.

Emotional Performance:

The counselling scenes depended on natural and restrained performances, so more takes were sometimes required to get the right emotion and delivery.

Two Timelines:

Keeping the present and the flashback visually consistent within themselves, but clearly different from each other, required planning in shooting and colour correction.

Limited Equipment and Locations:

The production used simple equipment and available locations, which needed careful planning to obtain usable footage and audio.

6.3 Learning Outcomes

The project provided practical experience across the full filmmaking workflow. The major learning outcomes include:

- Understanding how a story idea can be developed into a screenplay.
- Learning the importance of scene planning and continuity.
- Gaining practical experience in directing actors, including handling emotional scenes.
- Understanding basic camera framing and shot composition.
- Learning to work within equipment and location limitations.
- Understanding how sound and music support storytelling.

- Learning video editing and how to intercut two timelines.
- Understanding colour correction and how colour can express mood.
- Learning how symbols such as the backpack and the sea can carry meaning.
- Developing teamwork, communication and time-management skills.

6.4 Overall Conclusion

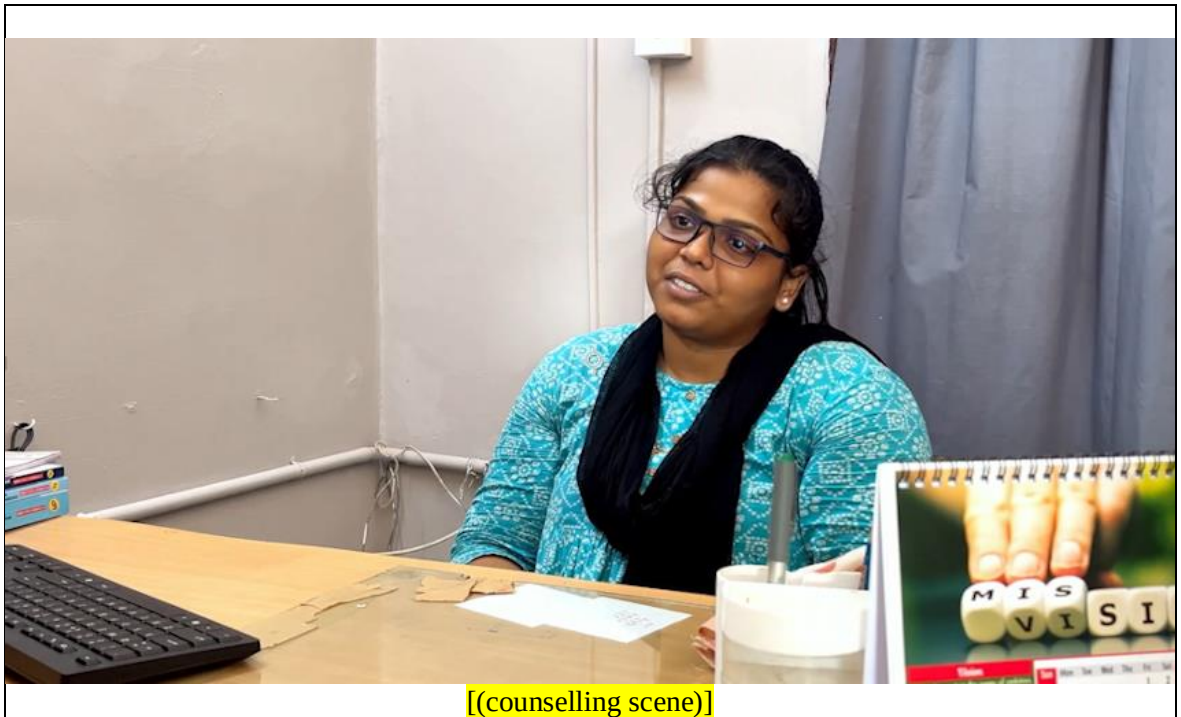
The making of "**Naan**" gave practical exposure to the different stages of producing a short film. From developing the initial idea and screenplay to shooting, directing, editing and presenting the final film, the project required both creative thinking and technical execution.

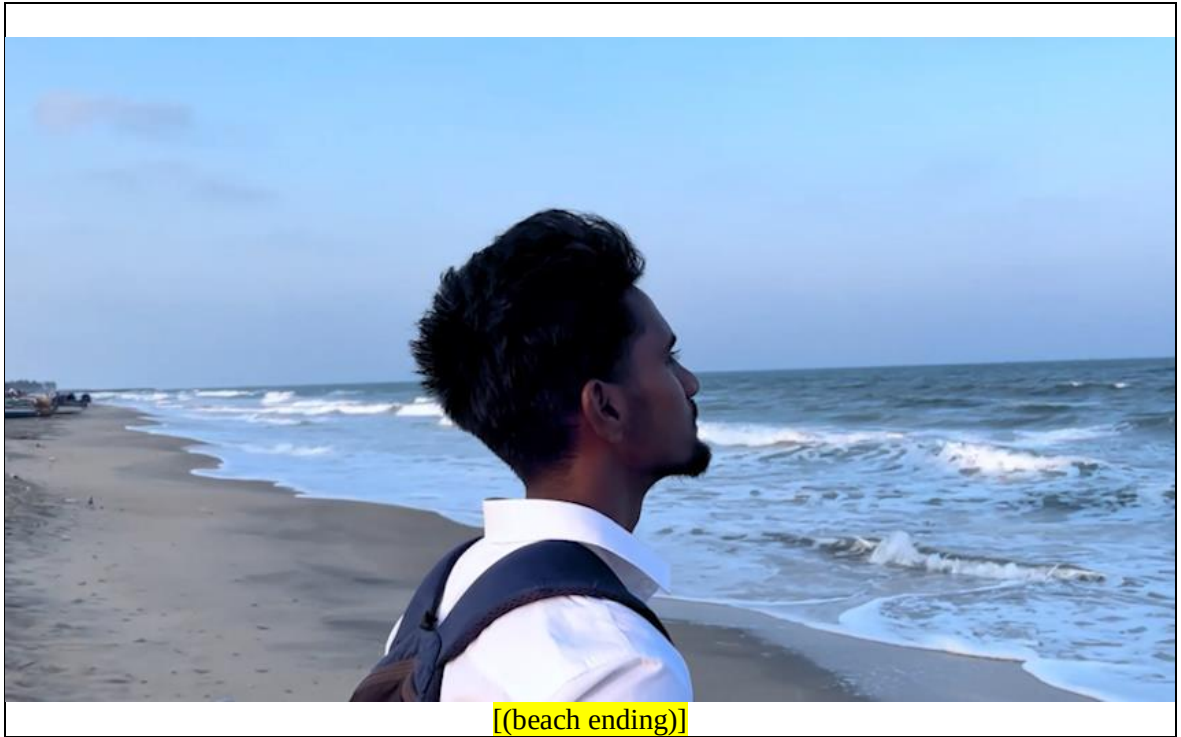
The story shows that the person who remains after bullying matters as much as the incident itself. The structure of counselling, flashback and beach ending, along with the symbols of the backpack and the sea, was combined to communicate the central message that we do not always know what someone is carrying inside.

The project also shows that filmmaking does not depend only on advanced equipment. A clear concept, planned execution and thoughtful storytelling can create a meaningful short film.

APPENDICES

Appendix A.2 - Footages





[(beach ending)]